

Quiz 2 and 3

Q1 Scenario

Bilal is a first-year student using his university's online portal to register for next semester's courses. The registration screen displays all 90 available courses in a single scrollable list, sorted alphabetically by course code. Each entry shows six pieces of information (course code, full title, prerequisites, credit hours, instructor name, and available seats) all in the same font size and weight, with no visual grouping, no search bar, and no filter option. After 15 minutes of scrolling, Bilal accidentally selects CSC-401 (a 4th-year elective) instead of CSC-201 (a 2nd-year core course). The system registers him silently (no confirmation dialog, no warning, and no success or error message). He discovers the mistake a week later when his academic advisor flags it.

- a) Each course entry displays six pieces of information in identical font size and weight. Identify which type of cognitive load is primarily increased by this presentation style.
- b) Suggest one Information Architecture change to this screen that would help students like Bilal locate a relevant course significantly faster. State the change.
- c) Name one Visual Design Principle that, if applied to the information inside each course entry, would allow Bilal to instantly distinguish essential details from secondary details.

Q2: Zara is a UX designer hired to build a feature that lets university students request a Leave of Absence through a mobile app. She skips storyboarding and opens Figma directly. After three weeks she presents wireframes showing: a form with 12 fields, a submit button, and a confirmation screen. During review, a faculty member points out two issues: the form asks for information a student would not know off-hand (like their faculty member's staff ID), and there is no screen for what happens if the Dean rejects the request. Her manager says: "You should have storyboarded first."

- a) Name the two types of storyboard used in UX design. State in one sentence each which type would have helped Zara avoid each of the two problems identified in the review.
- b) A colleague says: "Storyboards are a waste of time. We can just build the wireframes and fix problems later." Give one specific cost or risk that this approach introduces, in one sentence.